

CUDDLES CHILDMINDERS AND SCHOOLS

2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION HOME-SCHOOL PARTNERSHIP GUIDE (NURSERY 2)



Dear Parent,

Welcome to another exciting academic session at **Cuddles Childminders and Schools**

Nursery 2 is an important stage in your child's educational journey. At this level, learners are expected to become increasingly independent, confident and purposeful in their learning. We therefore place greater emphasis on **school readiness, foundational literacy and numeracy, communication, problem-solving, self-management and responsible behaviour.**

At Cuddles, we believe that the best outcomes occur when **school and home work together with consistency and shared expectations.**

OUR SHARED COMMITMENT

We believe:

- Every child is unique and develops at their own pace.
- Children learn best through meaningful, hands-on and purposeful experiences.
- Independence should be deliberately taught and encouraged.
- Consistent routines between home and school build confidence and security.
- Early academic skills provide the foundation for future success.
- Social, emotional, physical and practical development are equally important.
- Parents are active partners in their child's learning and development.

We invite you to work closely with us throughout the session to help your child make meaningful progress.

NURSERY 2 LEARNING EXPECTATIONS

By the end of the academic session, learners will be supported to demonstrate increasing competence in the following areas:

1. EARLY NUMERACY & COGNITIVE DEVELOPMENT

Learners should be able to:

- Count sequentially from **0–1,000** with increasing accuracy.
- Skip-count in **2s, 5s and 10s up to 200**.
- Recognise, read, write and spell numbers and milestone numbers up to **1,000**, as developmentally appropriate.
- Demonstrate an understanding of number quantity and sequence.
- Solve simple addition and subtraction problems using objects, pictures and everyday situations.
- Understand and identify **whole, half and quarter**.
- Recognise and use ordinal numbers such as **first, second, third**.
- Identify and extend simple patterns.
- Recognise and describe common shapes and their properties.
- Identify primary and secondary colours.
- Understand basic concepts of size, position, direction and measurement.
- Tell time to the **hour**.
- Compare objects using concepts such as longer/shorter, heavier/lighter, bigger/smaller and more/less.
- Recognise Nigerian currency and solve simple age-appropriate money problems.
- Apply mathematical thinking to familiar real-life situations.
- Complete age-appropriate puzzles, mazes, matching and observation activities.
- Demonstrate growing ability to classify, compare, sequence and organise information.

2. EARLY LITERACY, PHONICS & COMMUNICATION

Learners will be supported to:

- Write uppercase and lowercase letters correctly.
- Identify and distinguish **vowels and consonants**.
- Recognise and use the articles **a** and **an** appropriately.
- Demonstrate understanding of letter sounds and common phonics patterns.
- Blend sounds to read simple words.
- Apply knowledge of **Magic 'e'** in appropriate words.
- Recognise and read an increasing range of high-frequency and familiar words.
- Develop reading fluency through age-appropriate texts.
- Build a functional vocabulary of **400+ words**.
- Demonstrate understanding of what they have read or heard.
- Answer literal and simple inferential questions about stories.
- Retell stories in the correct or logical sequence.
- Describe characters, settings, objects and events.
- Express ideas and experiences in complete sentences.
- Recognise and write simple sentences.
- Develop early creative-writing skills through pictures, words and simple sentences.
- Use drawing and writing to communicate ideas.
- Participate confidently in songs, rhymes, discussions and storytelling.

3. WRITING & FINE-MOTOR DEVELOPMENT

Learners should progressively demonstrate:

- Improved pencil grip and control.
- Correct letter and number formation.

- Improved handwriting size, spacing and directionality.
- Ability to copy words and simple sentences accurately.
- Increasing ability to write independently.
- Improved hand-eye coordination.
- Competence in age-appropriate cutting, colouring, tracing, threading and construction activities.
- Ability to use drawing and mark-making to represent ideas and experiences.

Parents are encouraged to provide opportunities for drawing, colouring, writing and practical fine-motor activities at home.

4. GENERAL KNOWLEDGE & PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

Learners will explore:

- Parts of the body and their functions.
- The five senses and their uses.
- Basic personal hygiene.
- Healthy food choices.
- Basic health and safety practices.
- Family and community.
- Their immediate environment.
- Common occupations and community helpers.
- Nature, animals and the environment.
- Basic awareness of time, routines and daily activities.

The objective is to help children **connect classroom learning to the world around them.**

5. SELF-HELP & INDEPENDENCE

Nursery 2 learners are expected to develop increasing independence in:

- Using the bathroom independently and maintaining appropriate hygiene.

© Cuddles Childminders & Schools

- Feeding themselves and cleaning up after meals.
- Putting on and removing shoes.
- Beginning to tie and untie shoelaces where developmentally appropriate.
- Managing their school bag and personal belongings.
- Packing away materials after activities.
- Keeping their immediate workspace tidy.
- Completing simple tasks without constant adult prompting.
- Asking appropriately for assistance when needed.
- Following two- to three-step instructions.
- Completing homework with minimal support.

A NOTE TO PARENTS

Please resist the temptation to do everything for your child.

At this stage, **independence is part of learning**. Allow your child to try, make mistakes, correct them and try again. Support should be available, but it should not replace the child's effort.

SCHOOL ROUTINES & EXPECTATIONS

School Hours

School Opens: 7:30 a.m.

School Closes: 3:15 p.m.

A **15-minute grace period** is provided after closing time. Thereafter, a **₦1,000 per hour late pick-up charge** applies.

Parents are expected to make reliable arrangements for the timely collection of their children.

School closures may occur due to public holidays, emergencies, government directives or circumstances affecting the health and safety of learners and staff.

DAILY REQUIREMENTS

Your child should come to school with:

- A nutritious packed lunch in an insulated food container.
- A healthy fruit snack.
- A labelled water bottle.
- Personal cutlery.
- Breakfast taken **before arriving at school**.
- A suitable school bag.
- Any additional items specifically requested by the school.

All personal belongings must be clearly labelled with your child's full name.

Grooming

Children should arrive clean, neat and appropriately groomed.

Girls should wear simple, practical hairstyles. **Beads are not permitted** because of safety considerations.

⊘ PROHIBITED ITEMS

Unless specifically requested by the school, learners should not bring:

- Toys
- Candy or sweets
- Biscuits
- Chewing gum
- Juice or sugary drinks
- Money
- Unauthorised food items

These restrictions help us maintain a safe, focused and healthy learning environment.

📅 HOMEWORK & PROJECTS

Homework

Homework reinforces classroom learning and develops responsibility.

- Homework may be assigned **every other school day**.
- Homework should generally take **no more than 60 minutes**.
- Parents may guide and encourage their children but should not complete assignments on their behalf.
- Completed homework should reflect the child's own effort.

Projects

Projects form part of the learner's educational experience.

- Participation is **mandatory**.
- Projects may be assessed and contribute to continuous assessment.
- Parents may provide materials and reasonable guidance.
- The child's participation and understanding should remain evident.

The purpose of a project is to develop the child—not to showcase the parent's creativity.

HEALTH, WELLNESS & SAFETY

The health and safety of our learners and staff is a shared responsibility.

Children who are unwell should remain at home until they have sufficiently recovered and are fit to participate fully in school activities.

Please keep your child at home if they:

- Have a temperature of **38°C or above**.
- Are experiencing repeated vomiting or diarrhoea.
- Have symptoms of a contagious illness.
- Have chickenpox, measles or another communicable disease.
- Have conjunctivitis, impetigo or an unexplained concerning rash.
- Are experiencing significant physical discomfort or distress.
- Have an injury or condition that requires care beyond what the school can safely provide.

Where a learner becomes unwell at school, the school will contact the parent or authorised emergency contact. The child may be moved to a **supervised Recovery Bay** while awaiting collection.

Parents are expected to make **prompt arrangements for collection** when contacted.

Outdoor Play

Outdoor play and physical activity form an important part of the Nursery 2 programme and will be provided unless weather, safety considerations or appropriate medical advice indicate otherwise.

MEDICATION

Medication will only be administered in accordance with the school's medication procedures.

All medication must:

- Be clearly labelled with the child's name.
- Be accompanied by appropriate parental authorisation and instructions.
- Be submitted through the school's approved process.
- Be documented appropriately.

Medication should never be left in a child's school bag for unsupervised use.

□ HEALTH & HYGIENE

Parents are encouraged to reinforce good hygiene habits at home, including:

- Regular handwashing.
- Proper toilet hygiene.
- Brushing teeth regularly.
- Covering the mouth and nose when coughing or sneezing.
- Proper disposal of tissues and waste.
- Regular bathing and clean clothing.
- Keeping personal belongings clean.

- Informing an adult when they feel unwell.

PARENT RESPONSIBILITIES

A strong home–school partnership requires active participation.

Parents are expected to:

- Ensure regular and punctual attendance.
- Read and respond to school communications.
- Support classroom routines and expectations at home.
- Encourage independent learning and self-help skills.
- Support reading and age-appropriate learning activities at home.
- Ensure homework is completed consistently.
- Provide required project materials when requested.
- Attend parent–teacher conferences and relevant school events.
- Provide accurate and current emergency contact information.
- Inform the school of circumstances that may reasonably affect their child's learning, behaviour or wellbeing.
- Communicate concerns respectfully through the appropriate school channels.

HOW YOU CAN SUPPORT LEARNING AT HOME

Learning does not stop at the school gate.

Parents can reinforce Nursery 2 learning by:

- Reading with their child every day.
- Asking questions about stories and encouraging the child to retell them.
- Practising letter sounds and simple words.
- Counting everyday objects.
- Practising number recognition and simple calculations.

- Allowing children to help with safe household tasks.
- Encouraging children to dress, feed and organise themselves.
- Asking children to describe what they see, hear, feel and observe.
- Playing age-appropriate puzzles, matching and sequencing games.
- Encouraging conversation rather than relying excessively on screens.
- Giving children opportunities to solve simple problems independently.

Talk to your child. Read to your child. Let your child try. Let your child think. Let your child help.

These simple experiences significantly strengthen early learning.

FEES, SCHOOL PROPERTY & PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

- School fees are expected to be paid within the stipulated payment period.
- Outstanding fees may affect access to certain school services or activities.
- Parents may be held responsible for deliberate or negligent damage to school property caused by their child.
- Children should be taught to respect school property, shared resources and the belongings of others.
- Parents should use the school's established communication channels when raising concerns or seeking clarification.

Staff Appreciation

To maintain professionalism, fairness and appropriate boundaries, parents are discouraged from giving staff members cash gifts or personal financial incentives.

Verbal appreciation, written feedback and formal recognition are always welcome.

OUR SHARED GOAL

Our goal at Nursery 2 is not simply to prepare children for the next class.

We are building the foundations for children who can:

**THINK • COMMUNICATE • CREATE • SOLVE • PARTICIPATE • CARE • INDEPENDENTLY
ACT**

We want every learner to leave Nursery 2 with stronger foundational skills, greater confidence, increasing independence and a genuine enthusiasm for learning.

Thank you for entrusting **Cuddles Childminders and Schools** with your child's education and development.

We look forward to partnering with you for a productive, purposeful and joyful academic year.

Warm regards,

**Mrs. Bukola Odomo
Head of School
Cuddles Childminders and Schools**